

NORTH KOREA

North Korea (DPRK): Key Country Details

Detail	Information
Official Name	Democratic People's Republic of Korea (DPRK)
Short Form	North Korea
Capital	Pyongyang
Region (UN)	Asia-Pacific Group
Government Type	Single-party socialist state
Supreme Leader	Kim Jong-un (as of 2025)
Currency	North Korean won (KPW)
UN Member Since	17 September 1991
Permanent UNSC Member	No
MUN Standing	Highly isolated state; nuclear-armed; sanctioned by UN

Book Recommendations

Book Title	Author	Why It's Useful
The Real North Korea: Life and Politics in the Failed Stalinist Utopia	Andrei Lankov	Insider political analysis and society
North Korea Confidential: Private Markets, Fashion Trends, Prison Camps	Daniel Tudor	Rare insight into everyday life in DPRK
Under the Loving Care of the Fatherly Leader	Bradley K. Martin	Historical perspective on Kim dynasty leadership
North Korea's Military Threat: How to Respond	Joel Wit and Robert Collins	Military and nuclear policy analysis
Escape from Camp 14	Blaine Harden	Human rights abuses in DPRK prison camps

Title	Link	Description
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UN Sustainable Development Goal 5: Gender Equality in DPRK	Link	Outlines North Korea's commitment to achieving gender equality and empowering all women and girls.
UN Women Data Hub – Democratic People's Republic of Korea	Link	Provides gender-related data and statistics for North Korea, including women's participation in various sectors.
Human Rights Watch – Submission on Rights of Women and Girls in North Korea	Link	Details human rights abuses faced by women and girls in North Korea, highlighting discrimination and violence.
UN Human Rights Council – NGO Submission on Women's Rights in North Korea (PDF)	Link	An official NGO submission discussing the status of women's rights in North Korea, including legal and societal challenges.
UNICEF – Situation Analysis of Children and Women in DPR Korea (PDF)	Link	Analyzes conditions of children and women in North Korea, focusing on health, education, and protection.
Amnesty International – Human Rights Report on North Korea (PDF)	Link	Covers a range of human rights issues in North Korea, including the treatment of women.
Cornell International Law Journal – Women's Rights in the DPRK (PDF)	Link	Explores discrepancies between international obligations and domestic practices regarding women's rights in North Korea.
U.S. Department of State – 2023 Human Rights Report: North Korea (PDF)	Link	Provides an overview of human rights conditions in North Korea, including issues affecting women.
HanVoice – Gender Equality and Discrimination Against Women in North Korea	Link	Discusses the underrepresentation of women in North Korean politics and society.
The Diplomat – The Dire State of Women's Rights in North Korea	Link	Analyzes the gap between North Korea's constitutional guarantees and the reality of women's rights.
UN Commission on the Status of Women – 56th Session	Link	Details discussions and conclusions from the 56th session, relevant to gender equality efforts.

UN Commission on the Status of Women – 57th Session	Link	Provides insights into the elimination and prevention of all forms of violence against women and girls.
UN Commission on the Status of Women – 55th Session	Link	Covers themes and outcomes from the 55th session, focusing on gender equality.
UN WomenWatch – Beijing+5 Statement by North Korea	Link	North Korea's statement on progress and challenges in implementing the Beijing Platform for Action.

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
UN Sustainable Development Goal 5: Gender Equality in DPRK	https://dprk.un.org/en/sdgs/5	Official UN SDG portal detailing DPRK's stated gender equality goals.
UN Women Data Hub – DPRK	https://data.unwomen.org/country/democratic-peoples-republic-of-korea	Offers gender-specific statistics related to North Korea.

Unique Aspects of North Korea at UNCSW

Aspect	Description
Legal Framework vs. Implementation Gap	North Korea's constitution and laws, like the 1946 Law on Sex Equality, claim to support gender equality. Yet, there's a noticeable gap between what these laws say and how they are actually enforced in real life.
Low Female Representation in Leadership	Women are still underrepresented in top government positions, with just 17.6% of parliamentary seats held by women as of February 2024.
Economic Participation through Informal Markets	In light of the economic difficulties, a lot of women in North Korea are turning to informal markets, known as jangmadang, to help provide for their families. This shift has allowed them to take on more economic responsibilities, but unfortunately, it hasn't come with the legal protections they need.

Gender-Based Violence and Human Rights Abuses	Reports suggest that women in North Korea are grappling with deep-rooted challenges, such as gender-based violence, discrimination, and a significant lack of access to justice.
International Commitments and Reporting	North Korea signed on to the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women (CEDAW) back in 2001. However, the country has faced criticism for not adequately reporting on or fulfilling its commitments under this agreement.
Limited Engagement with UNCSW	North Korea tends to keep a low profile during UNCSW sessions, often steering clear of any direct discussions about women's rights issues.
State-Controlled Women's Organizations	Organizations such as the Socialist Women's Union of Korea are indeed present, but their main focus tends to be on serving the interests of the state rather than genuinely advocating for women's rights.
Emergence of Female Figures in Politics	Figures like Kim Yo Jong have really stepped into the spotlight, sparking conversations about the role of women in North Korean politics. However, it's important to remember that these cases are more the exception than the rule.

Diplomacy